



Hacker attacks MTNL

A Pakistani hacker based out of Australia defaced MTNL Mumbai's homepage recently <http://dgit.in/17XmB0Q>

Checkout MixBit

A new service by YouTube co-founders that lets users upload multiple short clips or pictures <http://dgit.in/16z4MpY>

ASUS VivoBook S550CA

The VivoBook looks very different from the outset, when compared to most ultrabooks in and around the ₹60k price bracket. The HP Spectre XT, till the S550CA came along, was the only machine that had a truly sharp and edgy look to it, in addition to all the slimness. The S550CA does pretty much follow similar design elements. The ultrabook, despite



Dell XPS 12

sporting a touchscreen, doesn't feel heavy or bulky. The aluminum chassis is one of the best in this price bracket, and the angular yet sharp design gives it a very classy look. The lid remains very stable when using the touchscreen. The dual colour theme of black and silver is a good contrast. Silver adorns the lid and the keyboard deck, while the base has the black colour. The finish throughout is matte, with no glossy bits anywhere to attract fingerprints and dust.

Just like the Lenovo Z400, the S550CA is again an example of a machine bogged down by preloaded stuff – trials, free-ware and badly deployed utilities by the laptop manufacturer. Once you clean the installed app list and the startup, performance tends to show up in an impressive way. The fairly powerful NVIDIA GT635M graphics card – a rare aspect in

ultrabooks till sometime back, and that really adds another dimension to the overall performance aspect. You will no doubt be able to play the fairly recent games at medium-high settings without any dropped frames. The battery clocked 187 minutes in the benchmark test, which translated into a solid five hours when used as a primary machine at work.

The VivoBook S550's keyboard is slightly behind the HP ENVY 4 – which doesn't have a touchscreen – in terms of key travel, pressing force and key placement. The key size is good, but the spacing is a tad too much and the key travel is something we will rank second best to the keyboard on the ENVY 4.

ASUS VivoBook S400CA

The ASUS Vivobook S400CA's aluminum chassis is one of the best in the class, and the design is sophisticated. Adding to its charming design is its thickness which appears tapered and thinner at the front lip, and thicker near the display hinge. It is a little heavier than we would have liked for something that has a 14-inch display, which in turn is quite crisp, and text rendering is very good. Icons look sharp, and colour is handled very well. We are a tad perplexed that ASUS has packed in a Core i7 processor, but only 4GB of RAM. Had this been 8GB offering more headroom, the multi-tasking performance could have been even better than the current scenario, which is impressive in itself. Just like the bigger sibling, the 550CA, the 400CA

also has a very taut display hinge and makes touchscreen use feel like an integrated part of the setup, rather than something forced on.

Battery life is a touch disappointing, and a single charge cycle registered only 115 minutes in the benchmark test. This would mean a little over three hours of conservative use at best, if you are careful with aspects like display brightness.

Samsung Series 5 Ultra Touch (NP-540U3C)

The design elements on the new Samsung Series 5 Ultra Touch remain largely the same as the predecessor, but for subtle changes. Samsung calls this colour Titan Silver. The theme has been slightly altered though, with the lid getting a much darker colour finish. The base of the new Samsung Series 5 Ultra Touch has fiberglass, while the keyboard deck is of very good quality plastic. The fiberglass is a very light material, but extremely resistant to the usual wear and tear a laptop's underside would typically register. This was one of the first ultrabooks to offer 8GB of RAM out of the box, and the performance boost that offers is tremendous. The benchmark scores may not give it a much higher rating, but the real world performance is



Samsung Series 5 Ultra Touch (NP-540U3C)

where the difference is felt, particularly when multi-tasking. Unfortunately, Samsung stripped the touchscreen version of the Series 5 ultrabook off the graphics card, and that is a bit of a downer. The 13.3-inch display is the only ultrabook in this price bracket to offer a matte display, which makes this immensely comfortable for use in a variety of environments, with things not reflecting back off the display. At 297 minutes on the clock, the Series 5's battery is among the top scores across all machines we are testing in this comparison. This will easily offer over seven hours of battery backup in a typical "day at work".

Sony Vaio Pro 13

At 1.06 kilograms, the Sony Vaio Pro 13 is the lightest 13-inch touchscreen Windows 8 ultrabook that money can buy today. The super-light body is accordingly complemented with a slim profile that measures a measly 17.2mm at its thickest point. All the trimming on weight and dimensions might raise some doubts about the build quality, but fear not, Sony has not compromised on that either. The smooth (matte) finished carbon fibre body ensures solid build with almost no traces of creaks or bends that one would normally associate with thin and light laptops. It is no uni-body like the Macbook Air, which in our books scores slightly above the Sony Vaio Pro in terms of overall build quality. But, barring the Macbook Air, the Sony Vaio Pro is the best designed and built touchscreen ultrabook in the market in its class.

Coming to the hardware front, the Vaio Pro 13's base model runs on the latest Intel Haswell platform,